

The LinkedIn Headline Formula

The 3-part sentence that turns your profile into a search result recruiters actually click.

Most professionals treat LinkedIn like an online copy of their CV — a place to store their job title. That is the mistake. LinkedIn is a search engine. Recruiters do not browse it, they search it. Every day.

Your headline is the single most valuable line on your entire profile. It is the first thing that appears in every search result, next to every comment you leave, and on top of every connection request you send. If it only repeats your job title, you become invisible in a sea of identical titles.

1 Why the Headline Decides Everything

- It appears in LinkedIn search results before anything else on your profile.
- It travels with your name — in comments, posts, and connection requests.
- It gives a stranger roughly three seconds to decide whether to click through to you.

2 The Formula

COPY THIS SENTENCE STRUCTURE

I help **[WHO YOU SERVE]** achieve **[THE RESULT YOU DELIVER]**, through **[HOW YOU DO IT]**.

WHO YOU SERVE

Name a specific audience, not a general one.

Not "businesses" — "Sri Lankan startups", "B2B SaaS founders", "final-year engineering students".

THE RESULT YOU DELIVER

Name the outcome, not the activity.

Not "I do marketing" — "grow their digital presence", "hire without wasting a single interview slot".

HOW YOU DO IT

Your method, tool, or angle. Optional, but it builds instant credibility.

"through data-driven campaigns", "through structured hiring systems".

3 Before & After — See the Formula in Action

WEAK HEADLINE	STRONG HEADLINE — FORMULA APPLIED
Marketing Executive	I help Sri Lankan startups grow their digital presence, through data-driven marketing campaigns.
HR Manager	I help mid-sized companies build teams that stay, through structured hiring and onboarding systems.
Software Engineer	I help fintech startups ship reliable products faster, through clean backend architecture.
Final-Year Student	I help early-stage brands turn followers into paying customers, through content strategy and design.
Accountant	I help small business owners protect their profit, through accurate, on-time financial reporting.

4 Your Turn — Build Your Headline

WHO I SERVE

THE RESULT I DELIVER

HOW I DO IT

MY NEW HEADLINE

I help _____ achieve _____,
through _____.

5 Five Rules Before You Post It

- **Stay under 220 characters** — LinkedIn truncates longer headlines in search results.
- **Use the exact keywords** recruiters in your field actually type into search.
- **Delete the buzzwords** — "passionate", "dynamic", "results-driven" describe everyone and no one.
- **Run the 3-second test** — if a stranger can't tell who you help, rewrite it.
- **Match it to your About section** — the headline opens the door; the About section should tell the same story.

This headline formula is Step 1 of the 3-part LinkedIn System — Headline, Weekly Content, Intentional Connecting.

If you want your entire profile rebuilt using the same system used for premium, international-market clients, I write it for you.

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